seven categories are existent, knowable and nameable (if not by us, then by God).

If we say that Red Rum is a horse, we are categorising him as a substance (***dravya***). If we exclaim that he is a shining example of the family of horses, we are saying that he is an instance (***vyakti***) of the generic property horseness (***samanya*** or ***jati***). We can say that he is dark brown and of a given height and weight (***guna***), and that he can canter, gallop or walk (***karman***). Vets can also describe the natural integration (***samavaya***) of physical organs (parts) that makes him a whole persisting entity. As well as the individual object Red Rum, all those features are objective realities in their own right. They are not just ideas that we use to classify what we experience. The generic property horseness is a different kind of thing from the objects that it characterises. Colours and other qualities are objective realties. The property brown is different from objects that are brown. Running differs from individual entities that run.

Belief that integral to the structure of the cosmos are categorical distinctions between properties and the individual objects possessing them is one of the key points that distinguishes most Hindu (and *Jaina*) philosophers from their Buddhist opponents. The Buddhists deny that when we see a pot, we also detect a difference between a whole and its parts, or between the object and its particular qualities, or see the object as an individual instance of a separate universal. In fact, they think that temporary collections of features are what we (mistakenly) call objects, investing them with a permanence that is nowhere to be found.

Further reading: G. Bhattacharya 1989; Halbfass 1992; Potter 1977

Padmapada (700–50 CE): ***Advaita-Vedantin*** author of the *Pancapadika*. Whereas ***Shankara*** understands ignorance